THE COMMIT BOOK

THE COMMIT BOOK · PLAYBOOK

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Class of 2029 edition. Rules checked 2026-11-05 against the 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual
(printing dated 11/5/26).
Edition 2026-27 · Rules checked 2026-11-05 · Education, not legal advice. No outcome promised.
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> Education, not legal advice. Nothing here promises an offer, a scholarship, a roster spot or playing time. Confirm every date with each school's compliance office. `PROJECTED` = calculated from current bylaws, not yet published. `RECOMMENDED` = our suggestion, not an NCAA deadline.

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1. BASEBALL'S DIFFERENT CLOCK

Most D1 sports open coach messages on June 15 after sophomore year. Baseball opens later.

WHAT OPENS	WHEN (CLASS OF 2029)	RULE
D1 calls, texts, emails	2027-08-01 (start of junior year)	D1 Bylaws 13.1.3.1.1, 13.4.1.1
D1 off-campus contact	2027-09-01	D1 Bylaw 13.1.1.1.1 (rev. 6/24/26)
D1 official and athletics-involved unofficial visits	2027-09-01	D1 Bylaws 13.6.2.1.2, 13.7.1.2 (rev. 6/24/26)
Recruiting talk at a D1 camp	2027-09-01	D1 Bylaw 13.12.1.5.2 (rev. 6/29/26 eff. 8/1/26)
Written aid offer	2028-08-01 (senior year)	D1 Bylaw 13.9.3.1
Signing	`PROJECTED` 2028-11-08	D1 Bylaw 13.02.13.1(f)

D2 is earlier: in-person contact and official visits from 2027-06-15 (D2 Bylaws 13.1.1.1, 13.3.1.2). D3 official visits open 2028-01-01 (D3 Bylaw 13.6.1.1.1).

Roster reality: D1 programs in the House settlement are capped at 34 baseball players (D1 Bylaw 17.2, adopted 6/6/25 eff. 7/1/25). Fewer spots means fewer walk-on chances at those schools.

2. THE SHOWCASE BUDGET

Coaches look for verified numbers: exit and throwing velocity, pop time, 60-yard time (NCSA baseball guidelines; Perfect Game records the 60 and 10-yard split for all attendees). Before you pay:

- Who attends? Ask for last year's list of college coaches present. No list, lower score.
- What's verified? Timed by a neutral source, posted publicly.

- Is it a college's own camp? Then before 2027-09-01 the staff can't talk recruiting with you there (Bylaw 13.12.1.5.2). It's still an evaluation.
- Cap the season. Write a number before signing up for anything.

3. THE DATED CALENDAR

DATE	TYPE	WHAT TO DO	RULE
2026-11-15	RECOMMENDED	Counselor checks courses against the NCAA list	D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1
Spring/summer 2027	YOUR PLAN	One verified showcase; cut a 3-5 min skills video, best first	NCSA guidance
2027-06-15	OPENING	D2 in-person contact and visits	D2 Bylaws 13.1.1.1, 13.3.1.2
2027-08-01	OPENING	D1 coaches may call, text, email. Send first emails	D1 Bylaws 13.1.3.1.1, 13.4.1.1
2027-08-15	RECOMMENDED	Open Eligibility Center certification account ($110 domestic, waivers possible)	D1 Bylaw 13.6.3
2027-09-01	OPENING	D1 visits, off-campus contact, camp recruiting talk	D1 Bylaws 13.1.1.1.1, 13.6.2.1.2, 13.7.1.2
2028-01-01	OPENING	D3 official visits	D3 Bylaw 13.6.1.1.1
Before 7th semester	HARD	10/7 core courses complete	D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1(b)
2028-08-01	OPENING	Written aid offers may arrive	D1 Bylaw 13.9.3.1
2028-11-08	PROJECTED	Signing opens (second Wednesday in November)	D1 Bylaw 13.02.13.1(f)
2029-04-01	WINDOW	Request final amateurism certification	Eligibility Center procedure
Graduation	HARD	16 cores, 2.300 core GPA, final transcript	D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1(a)

Dead and quiet periods close specific weeks. Check the NCAA baseball recruiting calendar before booking any visit. TO VERIFY: 2027-28 baseball recruiting calendar dates (not in the Manual text we checked).

4. COACH SCRIPTS

First email (after 2027-08-01 for D1; any time for D2). Subject: `2029 [Pos] | [Bats/Throws] | [Verified velo/pop/60] | [HS/Club] | Video`

> Coach [Last name], I'm [Name], Class of 2029 [position] at [HS], playing for [club]. Verified: [measurable, event, date]. Skills video: [link]. Summer schedule: [link]. GPA [x.x]. I'd like to know what you look for at [position]. [Name], [phone]. HS coach: [name, contact].

Follow-up (14 days). New number or new clip, one line of interest, schedule link.

Call questions. How many [position]s in your 2029 class? How do you split aid across the roster? What would you need to see from me this summer?

5. SIGNING IN NOVEMBER

- A verbal commitment binds no one.

- Written offers may come from 2028-08-01; signing opens PROJECTED 2028-11-08.
- Baseball aid is often partial. Ask for the exact dollar amount and duration in writing. Use the *Offers & Signing Day* comparison sheet.

6. TRACKERS

Showcase ROI

EVENT	DATE	COST (FEE+TRAVEL)	COACHES LISTED	VERIFIED NUMBERS POSTED?	CONTACTS AFTER	SCORE 1-5

Contact log

DATE	SCHOOL	DIV	COACH	HOW	WHAT WAS SAID	NEXT STEP

7. SOURCES

- 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual, LSDBi 90008: https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008 — checked 2026-11-05. Bylaws 13.1.1.1.1, 13.1.3.1.1, 13.4.1.1, 13.6.2.1.2, 13.6.3, 13.7.1.2, 13.9.3.1, 13.12.1.5.2, 13.02.13.1(f), 14.3.1.1, 17.2.
- D2 Manual (LSDBi 90010) Bylaws 13.1.1.1, 13.3.1.2; D3 Manual (LSDBi 90011) Bylaw 13.6.1.1.1 — as cited in site/data.js, checked 2026-11-05. TO VERIFY against current D2/D3 printings.
- NCSA baseball guidelines: https://www.ncsasports.org/baseball/recruiting-guidelines ; Perfect Game FAQ: https://www.perfectgame.org/articles/View.aspx?article=18167 (guidance, not rules).